

Fatal error with .exe

I developed a software application in Visual Basic 6.0 with Oracle as a back-end and Windows 2000 Server. I receive a fatal error when I try to execute the .exe file of the application in Windows 98 or 95. However, it runs fine in Windows XP. Can you help me find a solution to this?

Silishi M

Check whether the program generates errors after installing Visual Basic 6.0 on a Windows 98 PC. If it does not, then you need to install the Visual Basic Runtime Setup, downloaded from www.microsoft.com, on the Windows 98 and 95 machines that execute your program.

Setup goofups

I have a P4 1.6 GHz, nVidia Riva TNT2, 128 MB RAM and a 40 GB hard disk running Windows XP Home. DirectX 9.0b is installed. I had initiated the setup for an application that automatically downloads

files from the server. However, I cancelled that and installed it later from an offline setup pack. Now, whenever Windows starts up, it prompts me to connect to the Internet. On clicking Cancel, it indicates that the auto setup failed and a complete setup icon is placed on my desktop.

Also, while playing *The Hulk*, I get a DirectX error even before the main menu loads.

Shitanshu

You have described the problem too vaguely for us to determine the cause of the Internet connection error message. Assuming that the auto setup you're referring to is the Windows Update Web site, you could try turning off Auto Update to resolve it. To do this, go to **Control Panel > System** and click on 'Automatic Updates', and uncheck the 'Keep my computer up to date' box.

Your system does not meet the minimum requirements of *The Hulk*. You need a graphics card such as the ones from

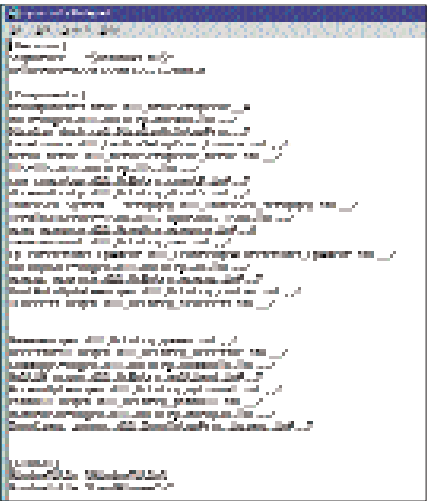
GeForce2 that supports hardware transform and lightning, and 256 MB of RAM, to play the game smoothly.

Deleting games

How do I delete the default games that come with Windows 2000 Professional?

Vibhor Mangla

Use Notepad to open the Sysoc.inf file that's located in `c:\winnt\inf\sysoc.inf`. Remove 'HIDE' from the line '**Games=ocgen.dll,OcEntry,games.inf,HIDE,7**' and '**AccessUtil=ocgen.dll,OcEntry,accessor.inf,HIDE,7**', and save the file.



When you open the file in Notepad, it will look as shown. To enable uninstall for a particular program, just remove the word 'HIDE' without disturbing the rest of the file

Next, go to **Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup > Accessories and Utilities**, de-select the Games option and click Apply.

Not smooth with games

I have an AMD Athlon XP 2400+ on an MSI KM266 chipset-based board with 256 MB DDR RAM and a GeForce2 MX graphics card. My PC does not run smoothly when playing *Quake III Arena*. It also takes a lot more time to load Windows 98 SE than my older PIII 1.0 GHz with 128 MB SDRAM and an 810E chipset. Another problem is that my processor heats up to over 53 degrees and often crosses 56 degrees when playing games.

Dhananjay Kulkarni

Jerky game frames could be due to various reasons—application conflicts, dated drivers, etc. Close all background applications, especially virus scanners, while playing games. No other program

Bits or bytes?

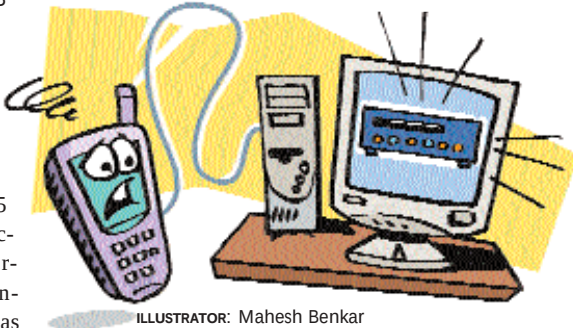
I bought a data cable for my Nokia 7250 to connect to the Net, but it turned out to be a serial cable. I cannot use the Nokia software since it works either using infra-red or the DKU 5 USB data cable. Some third-party software allow for transfer of files, but I cannot access the Internet. Is there a way to make this serial cable work? Are there any USB converters that I can use? Will they work? And lastly, will the Internet speed be better than dial-up? It takes me 20 to 30 seconds to download a ring tone of 7 KB - 10 KB on my phone.

Ishaan

The cable you purchased is a DKU-3 cable that provides serial connectivity, while the DKU-5 cable provides USB connectivity. That is the only difference. Once the mobile is connected to the PC, it appears as a modem. You can then use any dialer, including the Windows dial-up connection, to connect to the Internet.

As for the speed of the GPRS, it is 4.0 Kbps. The difference between Kbps and KBps is that b indicates kilo 'bits' per second, while B indicates kilo 'bytes' per

second. A byte is made up of 8 bits and requires a few error or parity bits. Hence, a single byte of data uses at least 10 to 12 bits. Thus if the bandwidth is 43 Kbps, then, in terms of bytes, it is 4 KBps. It should provide 4 KBps bandwidth, but as a general observation, speeds of more than 2 KBps are not available. Hence the Net speed is far inferior to the dial-up speed. The newer GSM phones support Enhanced Data rates for Global Evolution (EDGE) that gives you download rates of 21 KBps.



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Finally, you can use Nokia PC Suite on your mobile since it does not depend on the type of connectivity used. You may also like to try Oxygen manager software (www.oxygensoftware.com) that has most of the features of Nokia PC Suite.